Tree Falls Through Kennesaw Roof: What Cobb Homeowners Do Next

WSB-TV reported on November 5, 2026 that a Kennesaw family lost their home after a dying tree - over 75 feet tall and more than 15 tons - fell through their roof during an October storm, injuring one person. For Cobb County homeowners surrounded by aging hardwoods, the lesson is immediate: a dying tree near your roofline is a structural hazard, and the time to act is before the next storm, not after the crash. Here is exactly what to do if a tree comes through your roof, and how to spot the risk first.

The short answer: If a tree falls through your roof, get everyone out, call 911 if anyone is hurt, then document the damage and tarp exposed areas before filing an insurance claim. The bigger prevention step is inspecting aging trees and roofs before storms arrive.

Who this affects: Kennesaw, Marietta, and East Cobb homeowners with mature hardwoods near the home - especially older ranch and two-story builds with large tree canopies.

What to do: Schedule a professional roof inspection and have any dying tree within striking distance of your roof evaluated.

Timeline: Within 1-2 weeks of noticing a leaning, dead, or hollowing tree - and before the next storm season.

After a tree-through-roof event, Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors uses AI-powered drone inspections to map the structural damage and produce a photo-documented report before the adjuster arrives - evidence that strengthens your claim from the first day.

What Should You Do Immediately After a Tree Falls Through Your Roof?

Get everyone out of the house first, then call 911 if anyone is injured. In the Kennesaw incident, one person received minor injuries when the dying tree crashed through the home (Source: WSB-TV, November 2026). A tree that weighs 15 tons can compromise load-bearing walls and ceilings, so treat the structure as unsafe until a professional clears it. Shut off electricity to affected rooms if you can do so safely, since punctured roofs often tear through wiring. Once everyone is safe, photograph the damage from the ground, cover exposed openings with a tarp to limit water intrusion, and begin your insurance claim - in that order.

How Do You Know If a Tree Near Your Roof Is a Threat?

A dying or dead tree leaning toward your home is the single clearest warning sign - the Kennesaw tree that destroyed the home was already dying before it fell (Source: WSB-TV, November 2026). Watch for bare branches when nearby trees have leaves, fungus or mushrooms at the base, hollow or cracked trunks, and soil heaving on one side of the root plate. Metro Atlanta's clay-heavy soils hold water poorly after heavy rain, which loosens root anchorage and lets tall hardwoods topple even in moderate wind. If any limb or trunk could reach your roofline when it falls, have an arborist assess the tree and a roofer assess the roof's vulnerability underneath it.

Which Cobb and Metro Atlanta Neighborhoods Face the Highest Tree-Fall Risk?

Older, heavily wooded suburbs with mature tree canopies carry the greatest tree-through-roof risk. Kennesaw and Marietta neighborhoods built out in the 1980s and 1990s often sit under 40- to 70-foot hardwoods that have reached the end of their healthy lifespan, and a single dying oak there can weigh tons - exactly the scenario WSB-TV documented. East Cobb's established subdivisions pair aging two-story homes with dense canopy, so a falling trunk strikes a larger roof surface. In Roswell and Woodstock, sloped lots and Cherokee County's red-clay subsoil reduce root grip after saturating rains, raising the odds of a lean becoming a collapse. Sandy Springs and Dunwoody properties with tall pines face a similar threat, since pines snap rather than bend in gusts. Across Fulton and DeKalb, the common thread is the same: a mature tree in decline positioned within striking distance of an older roof deck.

As a GAF Master Elite certified contractor, Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors has completed storm damage assessments across Cobb, Cherokee, Fulton, and DeKalb counties - pairing drone inspection with on-the-ground structural review after tree strikes.

How Does a Tree Strike Turn Into a Roof Replacement Claim?

A tree strike almost always forces a full roof replacement rather than a patch, because the impact fractures the roof deck, snaps trusses, and splits shingles far beyond the entry point. Water driven in during the same storm then soaks insulation and drywall, so hidden damage extends beyond what you see from the yard. Insurance claims for tree-through-roof events hinge on documentation - photos of the tree, the entry hole, interior water damage, and a contractor's structural assessment. Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors provides insurance claims assistance and storm damage restoration, documenting every damaged component so the scope of your roof replacement matches what the adjuster approves. Quality new roof installation here also means code-compliant decking and flashing - a GAF or CertainTeed system backed by manufacturer warranties, not a cosmetic overlay.

What Does Cobb County Tree and Roof Risk Look Like at a Glance?

Risk concentrates where mature, declining trees overhang older roof decks - the pattern below maps the most common Metro Atlanta scenarios. Each row ties a location and housing era to its specific vulnerability and the action that reduces it.

Area	Housing Type / Era	Specific Vulnerability	Homeowner Action
Kennesaw	1980s-90s two-story builds	Aging 70-ft hardwoods within reach of roof	Have dying trees and roof deck inspected before storm season

Marietta	Established ranch homes	Large canopy over single-story roofline	Clear dead limbs; document roof condition
East Cobb	Older subdivisions, dense canopy	Falling trunk strikes larger two-story roof surface	Schedule professional roof inspection
Roswell / Woodstock	Sloped lots, clay subsoil	Loose root anchorage after heavy rain	Arborist review of leaning trees
Sandy Springs / Dunwoody	Tall-pine properties	Pines snap in gusts, puncture decking	Remove declining pines near the home

What Does It Cost and How Long Does Tree-Damage Roof Repair Take?

Costs depend on the size of the strike - a limb puncture may be an emergency roof repair, while a 15-ton trunk through the roof means a full replacement and interior restoration. WSB-TV's reporting on the Kennesaw collapse shows how a single dying tree can destroy an entire home, pushing the project from repair into total rebuild territory (Source: WSB-TV, November 2026). Emergency tarping and tree removal happen within the first day; structural assessment and permitting follow before replacement begins. For homeowners facing a deductible or out-of-pocket scope, Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors offers Wells Fargo financing to keep the project moving while the claim settles. Ask your contractor for a documented scope up front so cost and timeline are clear before work starts.

FAQ

Does homeowners insurance cover a tree falling through my roof in Georgia?

Most Georgia homeowners policies cover sudden tree-through-roof damage from a storm, including roof repair and interior water damage. The Kennesaw family's home was destroyed when a dying tree fell during an October storm, the kind of sudden event standard policies address. Coverage usually includes tree removal from the structure, though limits vary. Document the damage thoroughly and request a contractor's assessment before the adjuster finalizes the scope.

Should I remove a dead tree near my house before it falls?

Yes - removing a dead or dying tree within striking distance of your roof is far cheaper than repairing a collapsed roof. The Kennesaw tree was over 75 feet and more than 15 tons, and it was already dying before it came down. A proactive removal costs a fraction of a full roof replacement plus interior restoration. Have an arborist confirm the tree's health and a roofer assess the roof section beneath it.

How can an AI drone inspection help after a tree hits my roof?

An AI-powered drone inspection safely maps structural damage across a compromised roof that is unsafe to walk, producing a detailed photo-documented report. This matters because tree strikes fracture decking and trusses well beyond the visible hole. The documentation becomes direct evidence for your insurance claim, matching the approved scope to the actual damage. It also speeds the start of storm damage restoration by identifying every affected component early.

What are the warning signs a tree is about to fall in Metro Atlanta?

Bare branches, trunk cracks, base fungus, and soil heaving at the roots are the clearest signs a tree may fall. Metro Atlanta's clay soil holds water and loosens root anchorage after heavy rain, which is why mature hardwoods in Kennesaw and East Cobb topple even in moderate wind. A visible lean toward the house is the most urgent flag. Have any declining tree near your roofline evaluated before the next storm.

Is tree damage a repair or a full roof replacement?

A heavy trunk strike almost always requires a full roof replacement, while a small limb puncture may qualify as a repair. The impact cracks the roof deck and splits shingles far from the entry point, and storm water soaks the structure during the same event. A patch over hidden structural damage fails quickly and can void coverage. A contractor's structural assessment determines the true scope - don't rely on what's visible from the ground.

How much does a new roof cost in Georgia after storm damage?

The cost of a new roof in Georgia after tree damage varies with the strike size, decking repair, and interior restoration needed. A total loss like the Kennesaw home carries a very different cost than a localized puncture. Insurance typically absorbs much of the covered scope, leaving you responsible for the deductible. Financing options such as Wells Fargo plans can bridge out-of-pocket costs while the claim settles.

What roofing materials hold up best in Georgia's climate?

Impact-resistant architectural shingles from GAF or CertainTeed perform well against Georgia's wind, rain, and heat. These systems resist uplift better than basic three-tab shingles and carry manufacturer warranties when installed by certified contractors. A GAF Master Elite or CertainTeed Select ShingleMaster installer ensures the warranty stays valid. Proper decking and flashing underneath matter as much as the shingle itself for long-term durability.

How fast should I act after a tree damages my roof?

Act within hours to tarp exposed openings and stop water intrusion, then begin documentation and your claim the same day. Delayed tarping lets rain spread damage into insulation, drywall, and framing, enlarging the eventual repair. Tree removal and emergency roof repair come first, followed by structural assessment and permitting. The faster you document and start the process, the cleaner your insurance claim and the shorter your displacement.

Contact Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors for a free inspection.

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